



CNBC AWAAZ CONSUMER AWARDS '08: (Left) Actor Akshay Kumar wins the 'Entertainment Brand Ambassador of the Year Award' while (Right) Lalit Modi, Chairman & Commissioner of the Indian Premier League receives 'Commendation for Transforming Cricket in India Award' from Sharad Pawar, Hon'ble Minister of Consumer Affairs and Public Distribution

durability and rural centres listed easy availability as an important factor.

WHITE GOODS: With 66 per cent weightage given to reliability and trustworthiness, LG was the preferred brand with 23 per cent while Whirlpool was a marginal second (18 per cent) and Godrej coming in a very close third (16 per cent). The other drivers that were equally important were product durability, easy availability, sense of pride in ownership & prompt & responsive customer service.

CONSUMER ELECTRONICS: Here again, LG walked away as the preferred brand with 21 per cent. Sony came in second with 15 per cent, while old-timer Onida with 13 per cent was voted third. Reliability & trustworthiness had a high 72 per cent with superior sound quality, easy availability and range of products as the other important drivers.

TELECOM

Airtel, as the most preferred cellular service provider and Nokia as the maker of the most popular handsets were the big winners in the telecom category. The key driver for cellular service providers was voice clarity (48 per cent). But each zone's preference was distinct with North going for value for money, East voting for better network and South for interesting promos and offers. For handset providers, the ability to offer latest technology (51 per cent) was the key driver.

CELLULAR SERVICE PROVIDER: Better value for money and better network coverage were the key reasons along with voice clarity. With all of this going for it, Airtel was the preferred cellular service provider, garnering 36 per cent of votes. Vodafone came in a distant second (16

per cent) while BSNL was placed third (12 per cent).

HANDSET PROVIDER: Consumers gave preference to handsets that not only had the latest technology but also the ones which were popular (41 per cent) and looked good (30 per cent). Nokia with nearly 75 per cent of the votes was the clear market leader. Far behind were LG, Motorola and Sony Ericsson with just 6, 5 and 4 per cent respectively.

FMCG

Across the category, habit was the key driver HLL with its wide range of products walked away with the top spot for both personal care and home care. In the food & beverage segment, it was a tough fight between Parle and Britannia with the former emerging marginally ahead.

PERSONAL CARE: Apart from habit, more than 60 per cent of people gave preference to brands that were easily available and give good value for money. Hindustan Lever Limited, with 52 per cent votes, clearly emerged as the most preferred brand. Colgate Palmolive (24 per cent) came in second while Dabur (4 per cent) was a distant third.

FOOD & BEVERAGE: A closely-fought segment, Parle was the preferred brand with 10 per cent and Britannia following on its heels with 9 per cent of votes. What Parle had going for it was easy availability and value for money. Both Nescafe and Lays, with 8 per cent of votes each, came in third, followed by Tata Tea with 6 per cent.

HOME CARE: With more importance given to value for money and easy availability, HLL was again the preferred brand in home care segment with 46 per cent votes. P&G was a distant second with just



V. Ramachandran, Director Marketing, LG receiving the award for the most preferred white goods & consumer electronics brand from Subir Raba



Shivakumar, VP & MD, Nokia receiving the award for the most preferred handset provider from Sharad Pawar



N. Rajavam, VP, HUL receiving the award for the most preferred personal care brand from Subir Raba, former CMD, ONGC